

EXAM GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT

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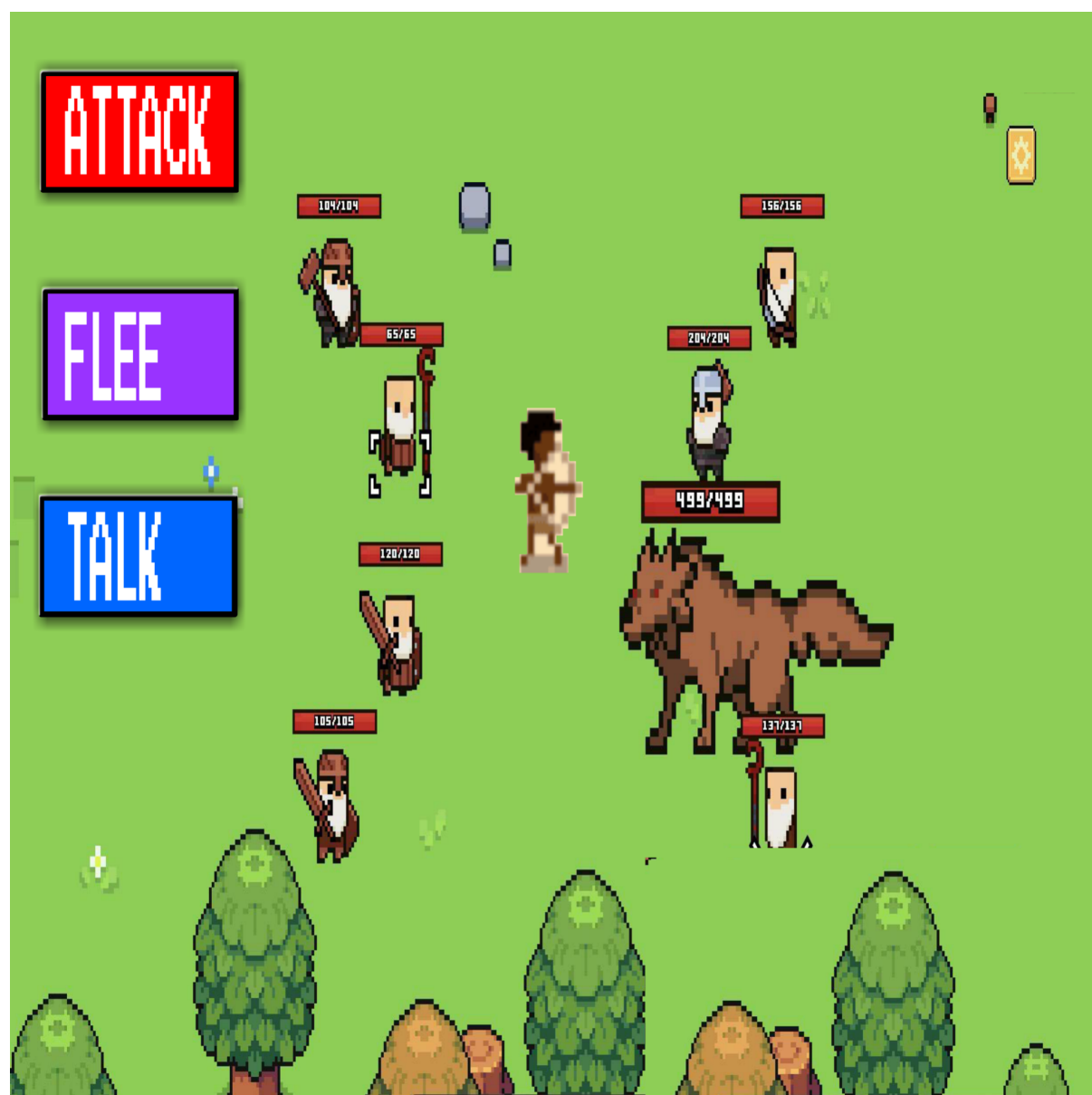
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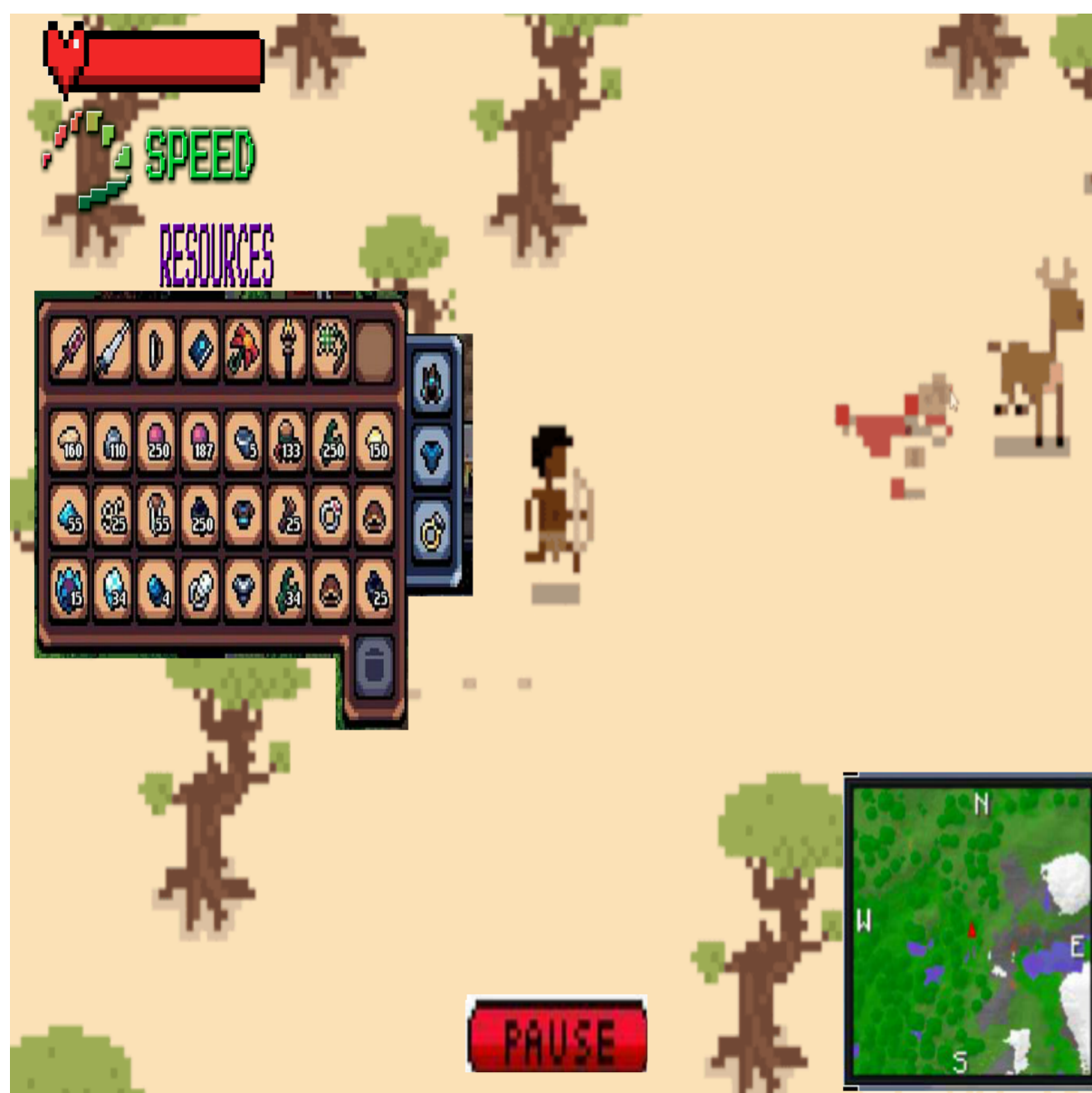
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UI WIREFRAMES AND IMPLEMENTATION









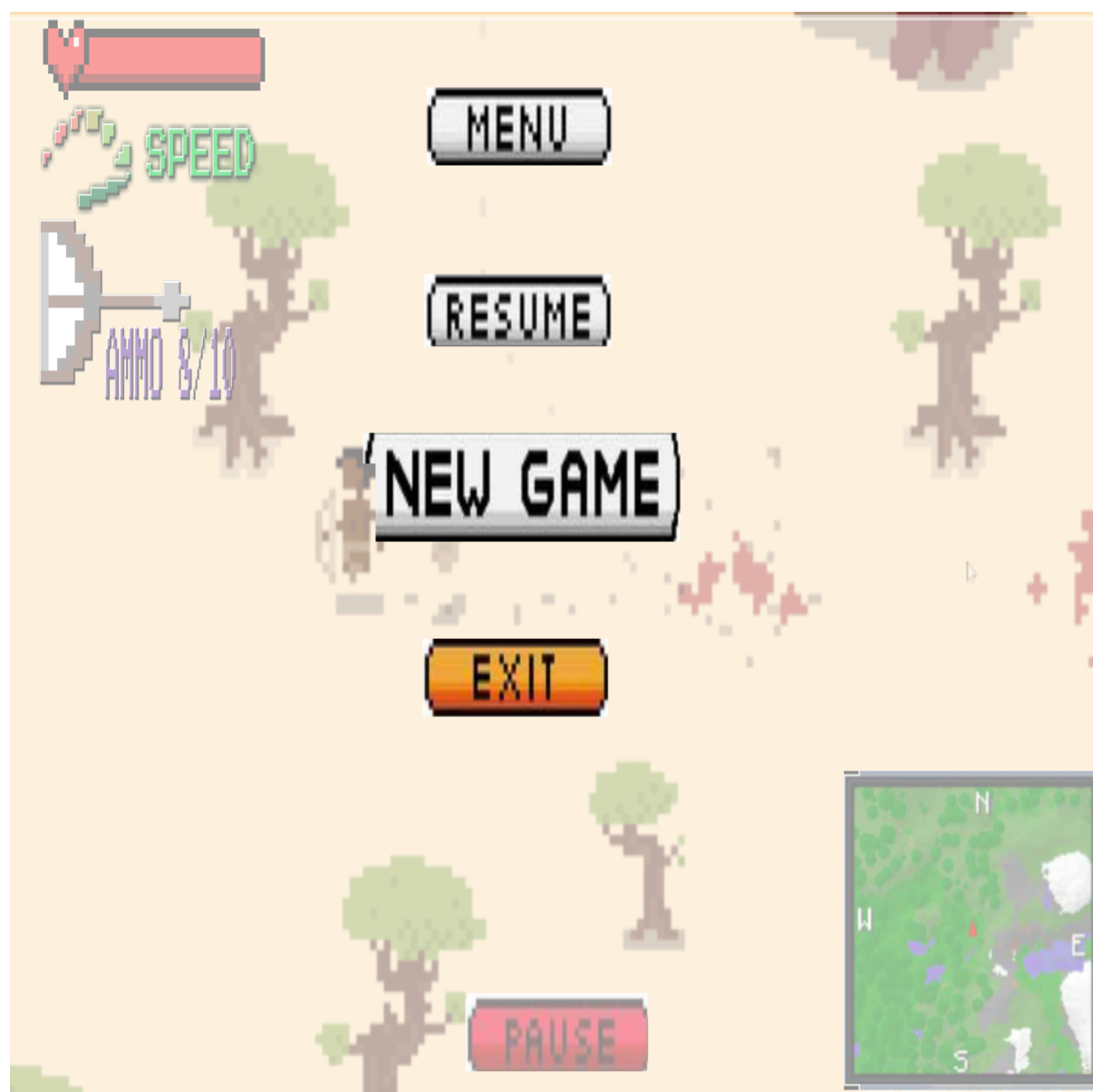
GAMEOVER

NEW GAME

EXIT

ALPHA
BETA
GAMMA



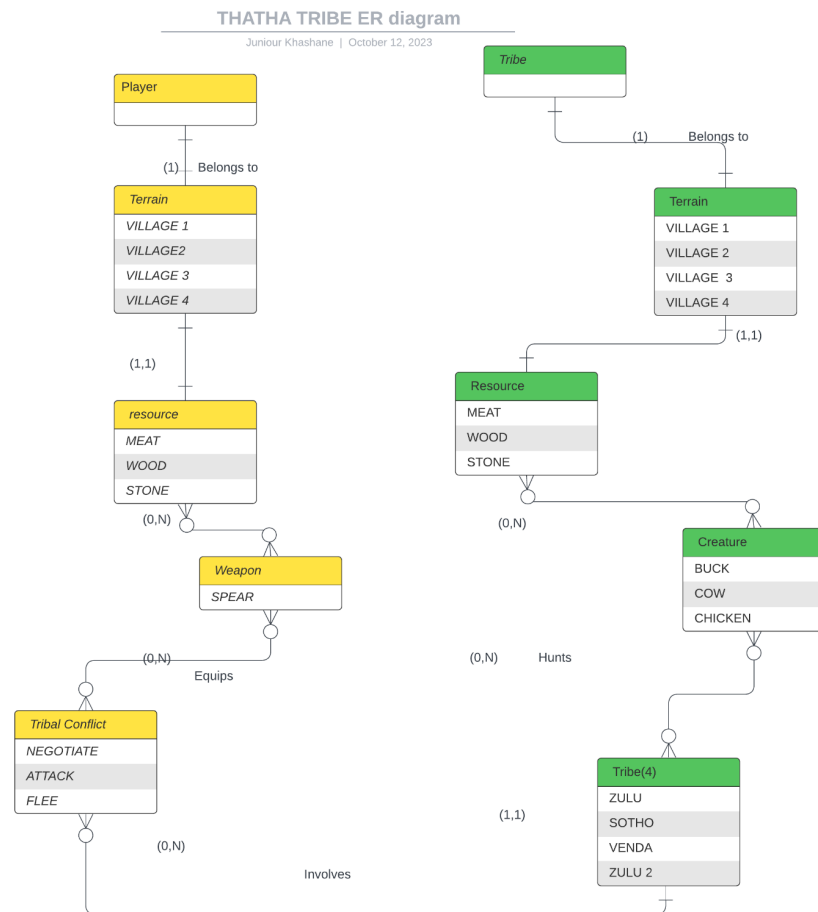


EXPLANATION OF UI ELEMENTS

In "THATHA TRIBE" various UI elements play a crucial role in providing information, enhancing player experience, and facilitating interaction.

1. Minimal Ammo Count Attached to an Arrow: This element displays the current ammunition or arrow count for the player's ranged weapons, such as a bow. It allows players to monitor their available shots and plan their attacks accordingly.
2. Health Bar: The health bar visually represents the player's or tribe's current health status. It provides feedback on how much damage they can withstand before succumbing to injuries, helping players make informed decisions about combat and survival.
3. Resources Tab: The resources tab typically shows the quantity of essential resources like food, water, wood, and stone that the player or tribe has collected. It offers a quick overview of resource availability and helps players manage their inventory.
4. Pause Button: The pause button allows players to temporarily halt the game, providing a break or time to adjust settings, access the menu, or check their progress without exiting the game.
5. Speedometer: If the game includes a mechanic for character speed or movement, the speedometer can display the character's current speed, helping players gauge their mobility and adapt to different situations.
6. Start Screen: The start screen serves as the game's main menu, allowing players to start a new game, load saved progress, adjust settings, or access other game-related options.
7. Game Over Screen: When the player or tribe is defeated or fails to meet certain objectives, the game over screen appears, providing a summary of the outcome and options to restart or return to the main menu.
8. Attack, Flee, and Talk Buttons (Tribal Conquest): During tribal conquest or interaction with other tribes, these buttons enable players to choose their actions.
 - Attack: initiates an offensive action against a rival tribe, triggering conflict.
 - Flee: Allows players to retreat or avoid a confrontation with another tribe.
 - Talk: Enables communication and diplomacy, potentially leading to alliances, negotiations, or avoiding conflict.

The effective use of these UI elements helps to improve the gameplay experience by providing players with essential information and tools to make informed decisions. These elements also contribute to the game's immersion and accessibility, ensuring that players can engage with the game's mechanics and story effectively.



In this Crow's Foot Diagram:

- The entities Player, Tribe, Terrain, Resource, Weapon, Creature, and Tribal Conflict are represented.
- There are four tribes (Tribe) and four terrains (Terrain).
- The relationship between Player and Terrain now indicates a one-to-one relationship (1,1) to match the presence of four terrains.
- The Tribe entity is labeled as (4) to represent the four tribes.
- The "Belongs To" relationship between Player and Tribe indicates that each player belongs to one tribe (1) and each tribe is associated with one player (1).
- Similar cardinality notation is used for the Resource, Weapon, and Tribal Conflict relationships.
- The "Equips" relationship between Player and Weapon shows that a player can equip zero or more weapons (0,N).
- The "Hunts" relationship between Player and Creature represents that a player can hunt zero or more creatures (0,N).

- The Involves relationship between Tribe and Tribal Conflict remains (0,N) to indicate that a tribe can be involved in multiple tribal conflicts, and a tribal conflict can involve multiple tribes.

Story/Narrative and how it will integrate into gameplay:

The story of Thatha Tribe is centred on a young man who sets out to defeat all the other tribes and defend his own tribe. At a young age, the young man lost his mother to a grave disease, leaving his father with a tough choice: accept his responsibility and become the new king after his father before him, or abandon his position in order to be with his son and ensure that he had a stable, positive upbringing. His father chose to cast away the opportunity to be king and instead spend his life caring for his son. As the young man grew up, he gathered a lot of strength and courage from his father's brave decision, and so he became a strong and fearsome warrior. At the start of the game, we control the young man as he is preparing to fight the other tribes and many wild animals that pose a threat to him and his tribe. Due to the young man's tribe being the smallest of all the tribes, the other tribes banded together and hatched a scheme to conquer the young man's tribe and merge them with each of the other tribes in order to increase their collective power. However, the young man and his tribe are not going to allow that to happen, as their pride in their culture, heritage and ancestors provides them with the strength and willpower to resist the machinations of the other tribes. Thus, the young man will have to be stronger than he ever thought he could be and go to battle with the other tribes, as well as all the wild animals in the wilderness that will stand in his way. The player will be able to fight enemies using weapons such as spears, shields and arrows, and they will also be able to pick up and craft items that will aid them in their journey. The player will also be able to talk with NPCs. In this battle to the death, the player will have to make sure that they and their tribe are the last ones standing after all the fighting is done.

Narrative Script:

FIRST NPC:

Young man! Thank you for taking charge. I have no doubt that you are as strong a warrior as your father was. He was extremely brave that day. Not many men would have given up the opportunity to be king in order to look after their child. After your mother passed... Well, he wanted to give you the best life that he could. They would have both been so proud of you...

SECOND NPC:

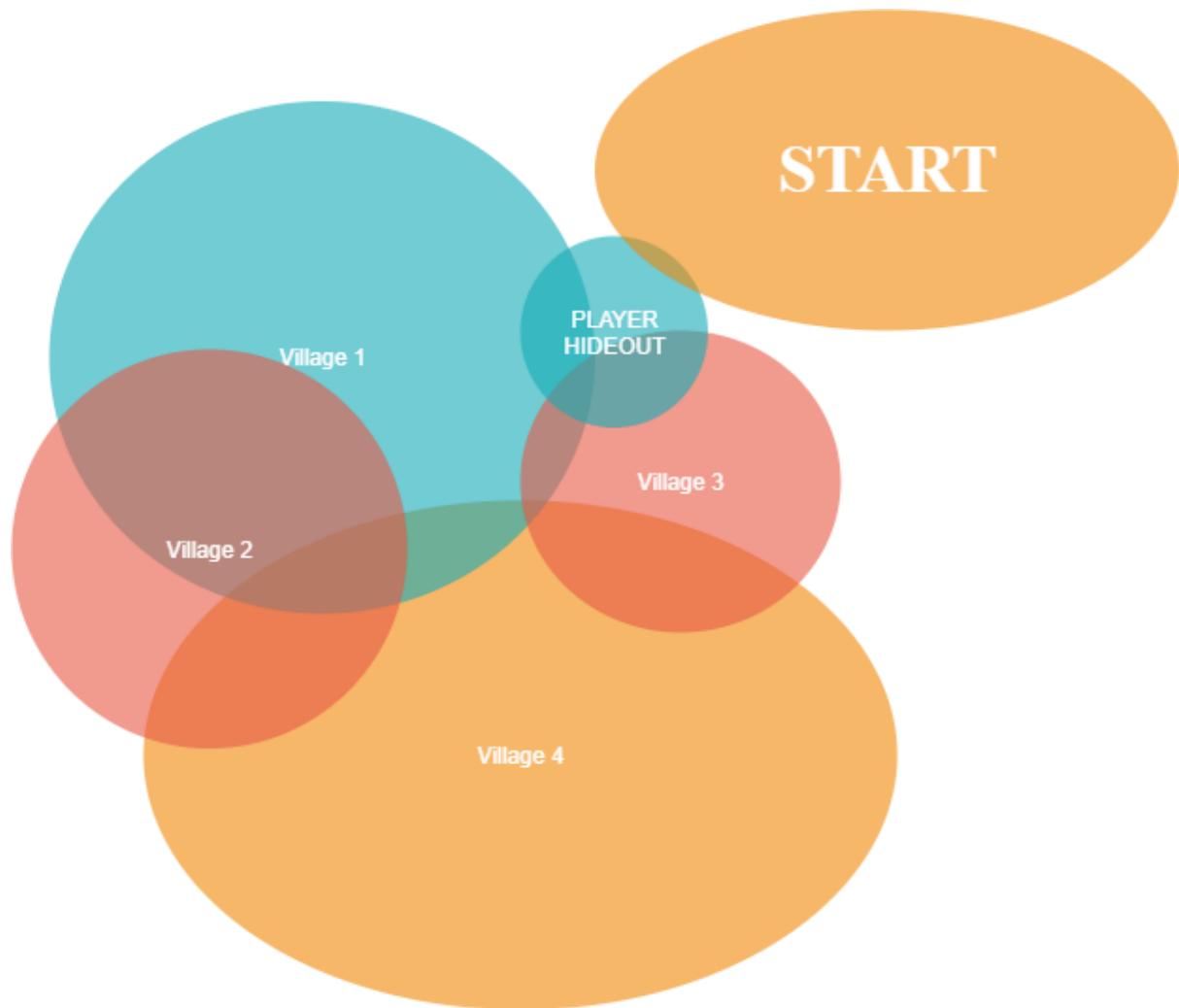
Those damned tribes! Who do they think they are? They think they can bully us just because our numbers are the smallest... We'll show them. No other tribe can assimilate control of our own! None! We must protect our loved ones at all costs, no matter who stands in our way.

THIRD NPC:

So we're really going to war with all the rest of them, eh? What a pity it had to come to this. However, we must protect our people at all costs, regardless of whoever stands in our way. After all, it was their collective decision to try to conquer our tribe to grow their own. Hmph! Did they really think they'd be able to get us to join their ranks? Most of us here would rather die than submit! It is a matter of pride and principle.

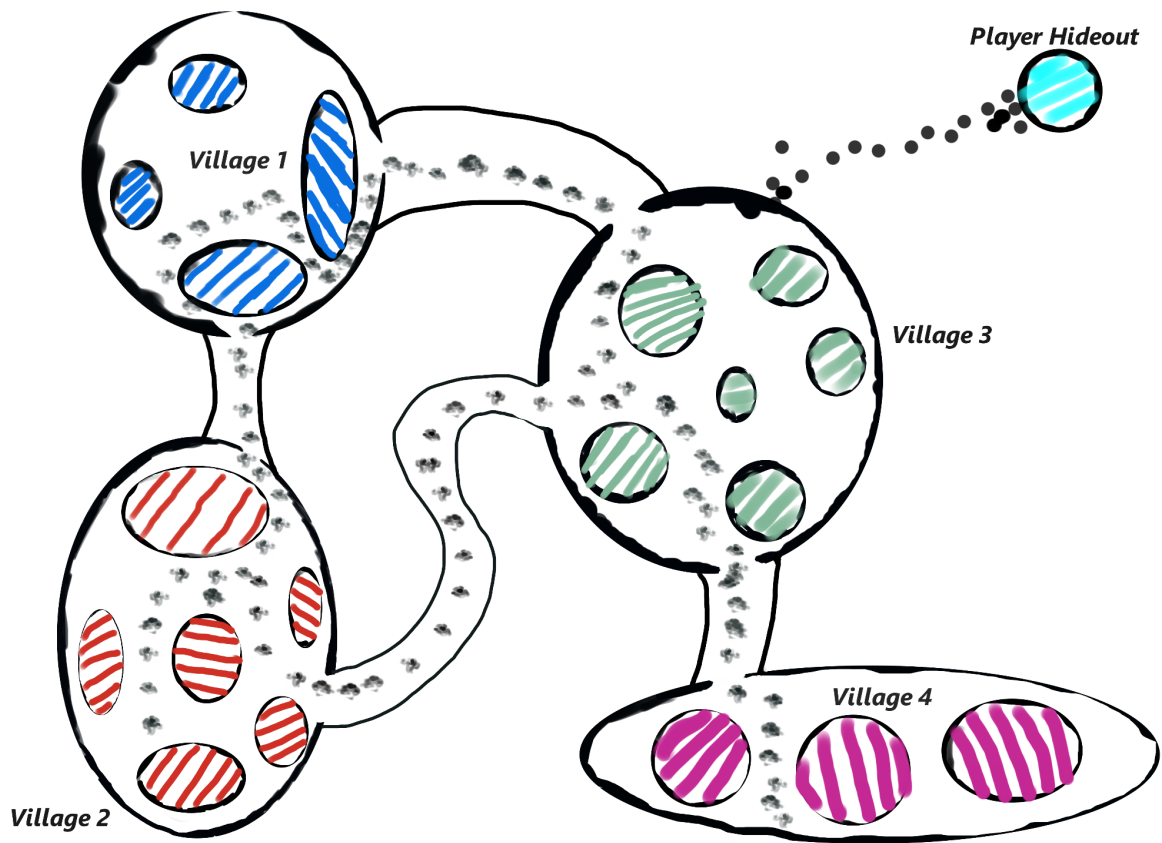
FOURTH NPC:

Ooh, you're going out into the wilderness? Best be careful out there... There are vicious animals who can't tell friend from foe; they'll rip you to shreds! Make sure you're prepared to take them on... or else you won't be keeping up the fight for much longer...



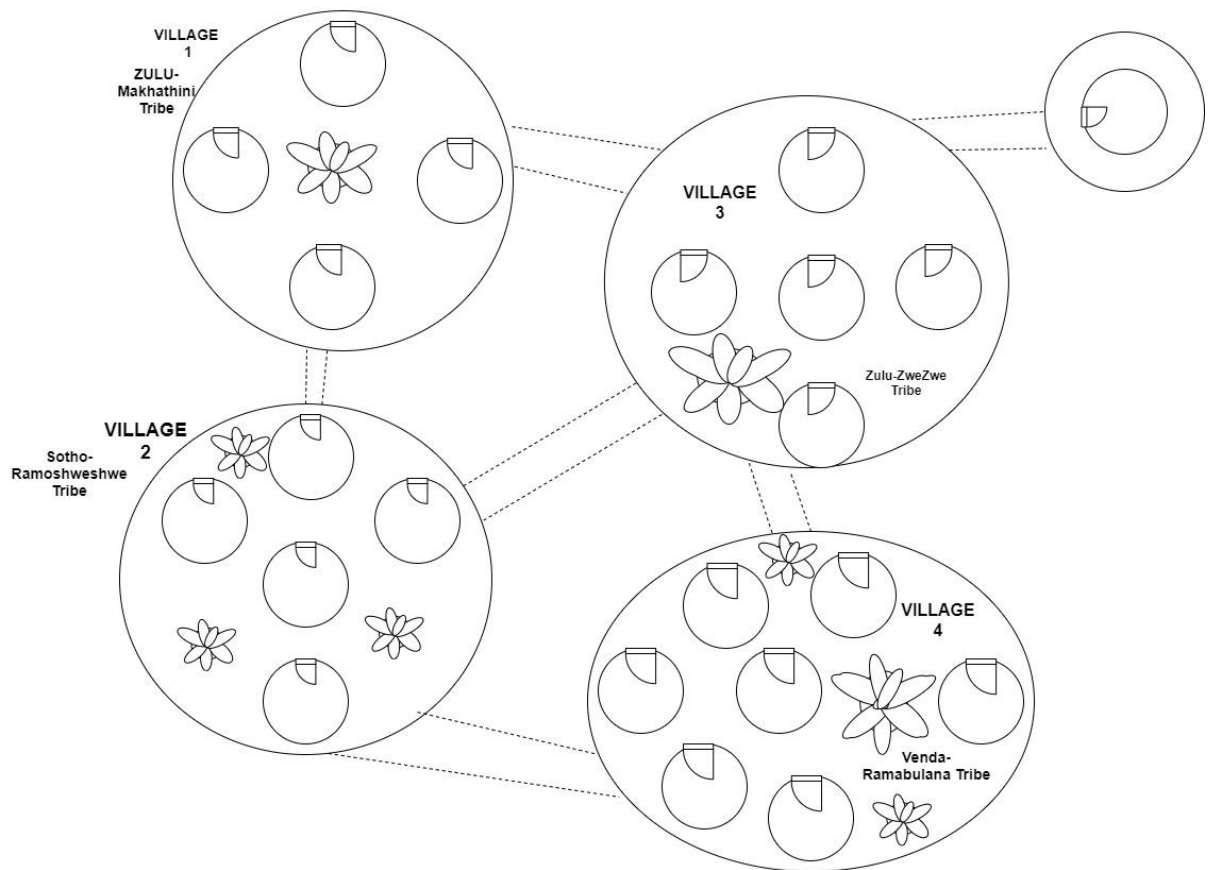
Bubble Diagram

The level is set around a large community of interconnected villages and these villages comprise of different tribes that the protagonist has to conquer to advance the narrative. From the players hideout the player can either follow route 1 or route two. Route 1 takes you through villages 3 and 4 then you progress to villages 2 and 1, these allow the player to go through the games as they please but they have objectives to complete.

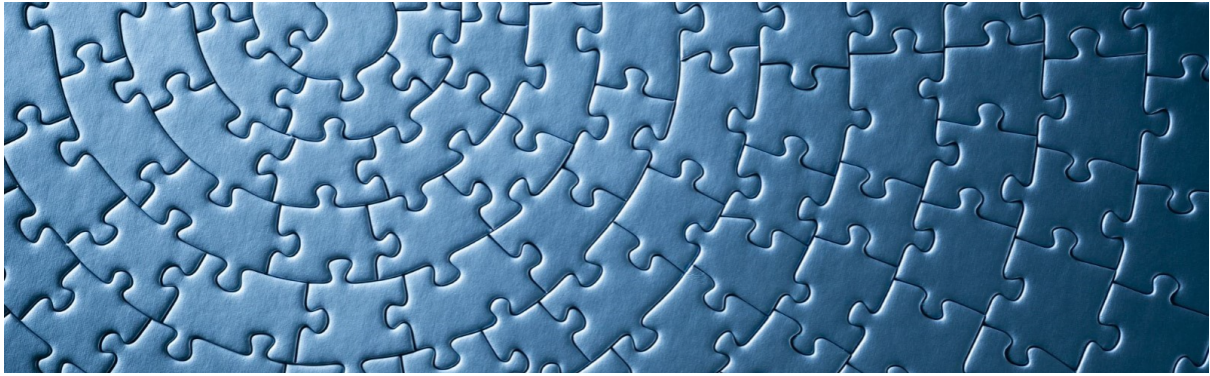


Key

----- Village Paths



Floor Plan



Puzzle design

Level 1

Mini-Game Idea: "African Safari Scavenger Hunt"

In this African-inspired mini-game, players will embark on an exciting scavenger hunt to gather specific resources required for crafting and health restoration. This mini-game is designed to test both their resource-gathering skills and combat abilities.

Game Scenario:

The player finds themselves in a lush African savanna teeming with wildlife, but they need to gather essential resources to survive and progress. The player has a specific list of resources to find: exotic animals, rare herbs, and sturdy trees. These resources are scattered throughout the savanna, hidden cleverly to present a challenging puzzle.

Gameplay Mechanics:

1. Resource Scavenging: Players must explore the vast savanna, paying attention to environmental cues, animal tracks, and plant characteristics to locate the hidden resources. They will need to use their keen observation skills to decipher clues and find the resources. For instance, spotting the distinctive footprints of a particular animal or identifying unique plants based on their descriptions.
2. Combat Encounters: During their scavenger hunt, players might encounter various wild animals that pose a threat. These encounters require players to demonstrate their combat skills and movement strategies. They must defend themselves while also gathering the resources they need.

Objective:

The primary goal of this mini-game is to gather all the specified resources without losing all of their health points. Players must use their combat abilities strategically to fend off aggressive animals and continue the scavenger hunt.

Success Criteria:

Players are successful in the mini-game if they manage to gather all the required resources and defeat the wildlife threats without being defeated themselves.

Success in this mini-game will contribute to enhancing the player's statistics and preparing them for the crucial battle against the tribal goons, which is essential for progressing to the next level.

This mini-game effectively introduces players to the mechanics of resource collection and combat, offering a well-rounded and engaging experience within the African setting of the game. It challenges players to use their observational, combat, and problem-solving skills to excel in their hunter-gatherer journey.

Level 2

In this mini-game, players will sit around a campfire, a tradition often practised by the Zulu people, where elders share stories to pass down knowledge and culture. The player's task is to listen carefully and remember specific details of the story being told.

Gameplay:

1. Listening Phase: The player listens to a Zulu elder as they narrate a story about tribal history, rituals, or cultural traditions. The story can be presented in text form on the screen.

2. Comprehension Questions: After the storytelling session, the player is presented with a series of comprehension questions related to the story. These questions test the player's understanding of the Zulu culture, customs, and the content of the story.

3. Memory and Recall: The player's task is to answer the comprehension questions correctly based on what they remember from the story. For each correct answer, the player earns points that contribute to their journey within the game.

Success Criteria:

- Players must answer a certain number of comprehension questions correctly to pass the mini-game successfully.

Rewards:

- Successful completion of the "Zulu Storytelling Challenge" can grant the player additional points, valuable cultural knowledge, and even unique in-game items or bonuses.

This mini-game not only aligns with the African theme of the game but also provides an opportunity for players to immerse themselves in Zulu culture, learn about their customs and history, and earn rewards that can aid them in their survival journey. It adds an educational and cultural element to the gameplay, making it more engaging and informative.

Level 3

This level will share similarities with the previous two levels because players will continue to engage in hunting and resource collection. This consistent structure helps us refine game mechanics and polish features, However this level will require that the player has already reached his Kingdom.

Mini-Game: Primitive Fishing Challenge

Objective: The objective of this mini-game is to catch a specific number of fish to gather food for your tribe.

Gameplay:

1. Setting Up: The mini-game takes place at a river. Players need to locate a suitable fishing spot.
2. Fishing Gear: Before starting, players need to gather or craft primitive fishing tools, like a fishing spear. These tools can be obtained by collecting resources in the main game.
3. Casting and Catching: Players will have a limited amount of time to catch a certain number of fish. They can cast their fishing tools into the water and attempt to catch fish. The mechanics may involve timing, accuracy, or a combination of both.

4. Fish Variety: The river or lake could contain different types of fish with varying difficulties to catch. Some fish might be faster and more challenging to capture, while others are easier targets.

5. Resource Management: Players need to manage their fishing resources wisely. Overusing their fishing tools can lead to exhaustion or damage to equipment, which can affect their performance in the main game.

6. Scoring: Players earn points or rewards based on the number and type of fish they catch during the mini-game. These rewards can include additional food resources, crafting materials, or even temporary boosts to their character's stats.

Purpose: This mini-game serves to enhance the player's ability to gather food resources, adds a fun and skill-based element to the game, and provides an opportunity to earn rewards and improve their chances of survival in the main game.

Balance Log and other data spreadsheet

Balance Log

Features & Description	Why is it a feature?	When do you introduce it	Beginning of the game/Introduction	Impact on Gameplay	Affordances	Consequences	How do you balance it
Weapon Management - A slot separating from the inventory only controlling and managing the weapons of the character such as Spears, Gwaras, shamboks etc.	To ensure that the player has easy access to the type of weapon they can use depending on the situation they are in			The pacing of the conflict whether it is playing stealthy or going guns blazing will ultimately depend on the player's gameplay.	- Ability to carry different types of the same weapon - Managing the count of them	- Can hamper player's focus - Can slow down the gameplay significantly - Player's could carry multiple weapons at	Players can only use one weapon at a time so that the weapons are not overpowered. The slot where players change weapons can make players switch with arrows and enter button to not slow down gameplay. Players can track animals for food however the tracks fade away after a few seconds
Tracking - The ability to find animals or tribes based on their movements whether it is the animals tracks and tribal indicators.	To ensure that the player can detect the patterns of the different animals and tribes they are gonna hunt	Beginning of the game/Introduction		The player has to gain the abilities of a hunter through the gameplay and they have to observation in their game.	- Observation skills being key for the player -	- Data driven - Limitations on movement	
Crafting - To ability to change the type of weapon you have based on the objects the players has gained	To enhance the gameplay quality as crafting make a new weapon and depending of the player's strategy	After the first fight		The resource/inventory management of the player as it all dependant	- New gameplay experiences - Various strategies can be implemented	- Can be overpowered	Player can craft and use these weapons but they have limitations to them such as only having 3 fire spears and 2 poisonously spears so players can only use them for big battles
Upgrade - A system used to increase the attributes whether it is the inventory or weapons	To not have stagnant gameplay and helping the player reach the minimum requirements for specific battles and objectives	After the first fight		The player has to meet certain battle requirements in order to progress otherwise the player could die	- Player Progression - Longevity of gameplay	- Very complex -	Players can upgrade at certain checkpoints or spawn points so that when they upgrade, it is only for that time until the next point to upgrade
Talk System - A system that allow the player to communicate with other tribes to resolve conflicts and instigate disputes between the players and tribes	To provide a narrative of the player's choices whether good or bad and enhances the gameplay experience	Before the first fight		Based on the player's choices will impact the gameplay and provide scenarios where the player can resolve or invoke the dispute	- Narrative input	- Slows down the gameplay - Impacts the narrative based on player choices - Could stop fight based on pressing a button	The talking can only be done before fights otherwise the conflict will continue as processed or how the player stealth can increase the ability of players talking to the tribes

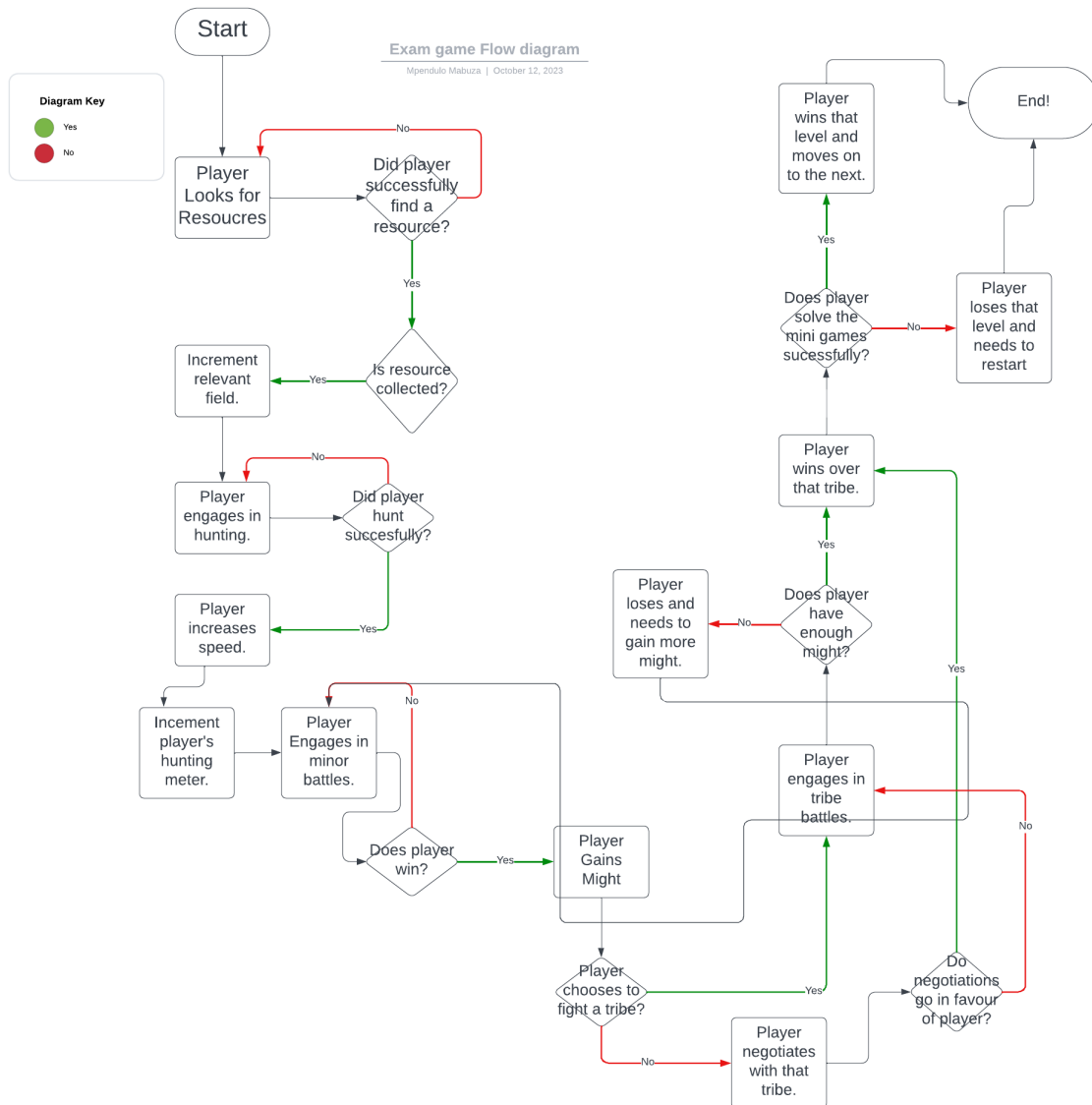
Balance Log

Details of Game

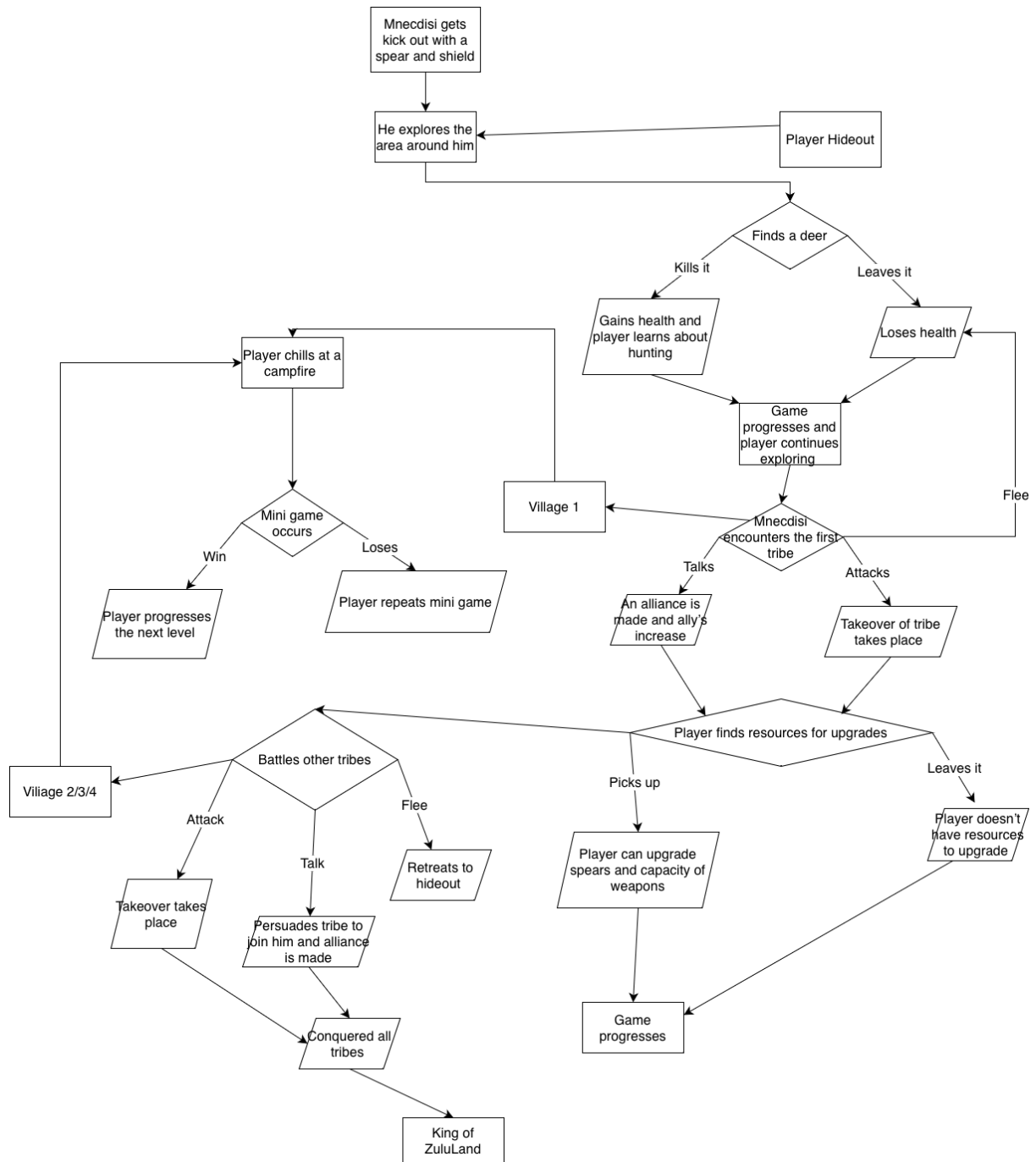
		Weapons	Damage(100)	Max Distance (m)	Special Attribute
Name	Thatha Tribe	Spear	10	3	N/A
Length of Game	20 - 30 minutes(TBD)	Gwara Gwara	15	0	N/A
Visual type	2D Pixel Art	Fire Spear	20	3	Fire radius of 6m
Main Character	Mncedisi	Poison Spear	15	3	Gradually kills and stick to entity until death after first hit
Objective	Conquer the Land and become King of Zululand	Shambok (TBD)	10	1	N/A
Speed (100)	60	Bow And Arrow	5	6	N/A
Health (100)	75				

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	Balance Log							
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17	Speed (100)	60		Bow And Arrow	5	6	N/A	
18	Health (100)	75						
19								
20								

Flowchart



Concept Modelling



Changes Made and Why

There were some changes that we made to our game from the initial ideas and concepts that we had for it. Below is a list of the changes that we made:

- There is no longer a negotiation mechanic/aspect between the tribes.
- The player now needs to defeat all of the tribes in order to win the game.
- The player can now pick up certain collectibles such as health, animal skin, wood and potions from killing animals.
- In order to find health power-ups, the player will have to go to several huts throughout the game.
- The player is now a "lone wolf" of sorts and does not have a tribe of his own.
- The change from a 3D game to a top down 2D game allowed us to more easily add more animations and enemies, as well as saving us from dealing with the major constraints that a 3D game would entail.

The reasons as to why we made these changes are listed below:

- Complexities that arose from having to figure out how to code certain elements.
- Commitment delays that occurred amongst group members.
- Discussions that were had of quicker and more effective alternative solutions.
- Time restrictions.